

Tung Lin (Sylvia)

tunglin.sy@gmail.com · Taipei, Taiwan · tung-lin-sylvia.netlify.app

PROFILE

Design researcher investigating how designed objects and infrastructures encode political choices and reshape everyday practices — often from within the systems they produce. Drawing on feminist STS, postphenomenology, and Research-through-Design, I examine the material and aesthetic dimensions of this encoding by materializing sensory environments and speculative prototypes to make their underlying conditions perceptible, open, and negotiable.

EDUCATION

MFA, Transdisciplinary Design

Parsons School of Design, New York · 2017–2019

Design as a research practice grounded in sociology, anthropology, and systems thinking. Thesis: Materializing invisible environmental data into perceptible sensory experiences (The Air We Share).

BA, Philosophy (Presidential Award)

National Taiwan University, Taipei · 2010–2014

Focus on aesthetics, ethics, and philosophy of science — directly informing design research epistemology.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

The politics and aesthetics of designed objects — how material culture encodes values and reshapes collective behaviour; postphenomenology and technological mediation (Verbeek), with a focus on how systems structure perception and experience; feminist STS and material culture studies, situating knowledge as embodied and situated; participatory and Research-through-Design practices as epistemic methods for surfacing otherwise inaccessible conditions.

SELECTED DESIGN RESEARCH PROJECTS

Speculative System & Biodesign · 2018

Beyond 100%

Exhibited at MoMA (Biodesign Challenge Summit), San Francisco, and RISD

Designed a speculative food production system requiring human nutrition for planetary survival. Materialized system artifacts to reveal the asymmetries embedded in efficiency-driven logic, exposing the raw costs of care and survival.

Sensory Environment & Physical Computing · 2017

The Air We Share

Parsons School of Design

Investigated environmental perception by building a walk-in geodesic dome integrating Arduino-based sensors, projection, and olfactory cues. Materialized abstract numerical data into an embodied experience, allowing air quality to be felt through the rhythm of breath.

PUBLICATIONS

Lee, H.-A., Lin, T., Chen, H.-I., Liu, W.-C., et al. (2025). Formative Interviews for a User-Centred Design Study on Developing an Effective Gateway for Biomedical Data Discovery. *Computer Science and Information Systems (ComSIS)*, Vol. 20, No. 4.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Lin, T. (2022). Launching Gateway to Taiwan Health Data. Panel presentation at the Asia-Pacific Association for Medical Informatics Annual Conference.

INVITED LECTURES

- Guest Lecturer, “Speculative Design and Design Thinking,” National Taiwan University GMBA (2021)
- Guest Lecturer, “Design Thinking and Philosophy,” Department of Philosophy, National Taiwan University (2021)
- Guest Lecturer, “Design Thinking and Creative Expression,” General Education Center, National Taiwan Normal University (2021)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Advisory Committee Member

The National Palace Museum, Taipei · Jan 2022 – Jan 2023

- Advised digital strategy and visitor experience research initiatives.

Design Strategist

Island Design Lab, Taipei · Jan 2020 – Present

- Led qualitative research and design strategy for public-sector and academic clients.
- Directed formative research for Taiwan's National Health Data Gateway; conducted contextual inquiry across five biomedical industries; co-authored peer-reviewed publication (ComSIS, 2025).
- Translated situated research findings into system-level design directions and strategic frameworks.

Senior UX Researcher

AJA Creative Design, Taipei · Jan 2021 – Jul 2023

- Designed mixed-methods research across performing arts, education, and technology sectors.
- Led discovery research on how embodied practices reconfigure in domestic environments during digital transition.
- Materialized behavioural patterns and structural misalignments into probes and frameworks to surface underlying systemic conditions.

TEACHING

- User Experience Research Training, Taiwan Biodiversity Research Institute (2022)
- Teaching Assistant, Ethics, Department of Philosophy, National Taiwan University (2012–2014)

AWARDS

- Presidential Award, National Taiwan University (2014)

RESEARCH METHODS & TOOLS

Epistemic Frameworks	Constructive Design Research, Postphenomenology, Feminist STS
Research & Design Methods	Speculative Design, Research-through-Design, Contextual Inquiry, Participatory Workshops, Strategic Foresight
Prototyping & Fabrication	Arduino, Sensor Integration, Physical Computing, Immersive Environments

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native) · English (fluent / C1)